

PASSAGE – 1

[CDS 2017 (I)]

I was abruptly awakened by a noisy scuffle. The sun, a mere fringe over the horizon, immediately chased away the grey halfdarkness. I was too sleepy to notice what was happening. Yuri was rolling over on the ground. I ran up to him but was struck dumb. With his right hand he was holding a cobra by the neck. Two sharp fangs showed from its jaws. The battle was over in a few minutes. A hollow hissing and convulsive jerks were then only reminders of a just-ended tussle. The catcher half-opened the lid of the box and calmly put the quarry in.

1. When the writer saw Yuri holding a cobra by the neck, he was 'struck dumb'. This means that he was
 - (a) extremely delighted.
 - (b) very much helpless.
 - (c) rather surprised.
 - (d) absolutely shocked.
2. From the passage, Yuri appears to be a man who is
 - (a) calm and courageous.
 - (b) cunning and crafty.
 - (c) noisy and dangerous.
 - (d) active and jumpy.
3. With reference to the passage, the following assumptions have been made :
 1. The incident took place early in the morning.
 2. Yuri threw the snake away.
 Which of these assumptions is/are correct?
 - (a) 1 only
 - (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2
 - (d) Neither 1 nor 2

PASSAGE – 2

Urbanization and industrialization have often resulted in whole areas of forests being cleared to gain new land and to obtain timber for the various building projects. Large areas of fields and forests have disappeared to make way for concrete jungles many of which are fitted with huge plants and chimney stacks. Industrial growth has necessitated the increased demand for fuel oil to run the machines and in doing so produces industrial gases and fumes which belch through the chimney and pollute the atmosphere. The

most evident elements in the contamination of the atmosphere are dust, sulphur dioxide, carbon monoxide and nitrous oxide.

4. The writer expresses the belief that
 - (a) there is plenty of scope for further industrialization.
 - (b) unplanned growth of industry has done more harm than good.
 - (c) the change from rural to urban growth is a change for the better.
 - (d) the timber obtained from the forests has been beneficially used.
5. The effect on forest areas produced by the activity described in the first sentence is called
 - (a) devastation
 - (b) deforestation
 - (c) disfiguration
 - (d) devaluation
6. The results of industrial development, according to the writer, are
 - (a) urbanization.
 - (b) no shortage of fuel oil.
 - (c) greater availability of domestic gas.
 - (d) greater fuel consumption and pollution.
7. The phrase 'concrete jungle' in the paragraph refers to the factories and houses built as a result of urbanization and industrialization. This phrase suggests that the author
 - (a) regrets that fields and forests have been replaced by city buildings.
 - (b) believes that too much cement has been used in building factories.
 - (c) disapproves of modern industrial expansion.
 - (d) would like to go back to life in the jungle.

PASSAGE – 3

I must say a word about the Eiffel Tower. I do not know what purpose it serves today. But I then heard it greatly disparaged as well as praised. I remember that Tolstoy was the chief among those who disparaged it. He said that the Eiffel Tower was a monument of man's folly, not of his wisdom. Tobacco, he argued, was the worst of all intoxicants, inasmuch as a man addicted to it was tempted to commit crimes which a drunkard never dared to do; liquor made a man mad, but tobacco clouded his intellect and made him build castles in the air. The Eiffel Tower was one

of the creations of a man under such influence. There is no art about the Eiffel Tower. In no way can it be said to have contributed to the real beauty of the Exhibition. Men flocked to see it and ascended it as it was a novelty and of unique dimensions. It was the toy of the Exhibition. So long as we are children we are attracted by toys, and the Tower was a good demonstration of the fact that we are children attracted by trinkets. That may be claimed to be the purpose served by the Eiffel Tower.

8. Why did Tolstoy disparage Eiffel Tower ?
 1. Man was foolish to build it.
 2. Huge man-made structures did not appeal to him.
 3. Men flocked to see it.
 Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?
 (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
 (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 2 and 3 only
9. Why did Tolstoy believe that tobacco was the Worst of all intoxicants ?
 (a) Man lost his intellectual abilities under the influence of tobacco.
 (b) Tobacco kept man in a state of inebriation.
 (c) People who commit crimes are invariably addicted to tobacco.
 (d) Statements (a) and (b) above are correct in this context.
10. Why did men flock to the Eiffel Tower ?
 (a) Men were attracted to the castles built in the air.
 (b) Men lost their wisdom under the influence of intoxicants.
 (c) Men were attracted to childish things.
 (d) Men were attracted to things of no value.

[CDS 2017 (II)]

PASSAGE – 4

For many years, ship captains navigating the waters of Antarctica have been intrigued by sightings of emerald icebergs. Scientists have now explained their mystery. There icebergs are turned upside down. Icebergs are blocks of ice that have broken off huge slabs of frozen snow called ice shelves. Their green appearance results from sea water that has frozen at the bottom over hundreds of years. The frozen

sea water has dissolved organic matter which gives it a yellow tone and the fresh water 'ice shelf' above has a blue tinge. When the iceberg turns upside down, it appears green through the visual mix of yellow with the blue from below.

11. What is the meaning of 'intrigued'?
 (a) Surprised (b) Fascinated
 (c) Muffled (d) Repulsed
12. What are ice shelves?
 (a) They are huge pieces of chunks of ice
 (b) They are frozen sea water
 (c) They are pieces of ice which look like shelves
 (d) They are huge pieces of ice which are very old
13. What are icebergs?
 (a) Huge chunks of ice floating on water
 (b) Frozen sea water
 (c) Green ice
 (d) Green yellow water below and blue above
14. When the iceberg turns upside down, it appears
 (a) green (b) yellow
 (c) blue (d) white

PASSAGE – 5

In its simple form, science has helped man to protect himself from Nature and to overcome natural obstacles to movement. But with the advance of science, a situation has arisen in which Nature need to be protected from man. He has used Nature's own gifts, not only of metal but even the human brain, to attack Nature. Forests are being destroyed not only to satisfy need but to provide luxuries. The evil effects of deforestation are already making themselves clearly felt in climatic changes and soil erosion. Man has at last begun to learn that he has to protect if he wants Nature to protect him.

15. The use of science in its simple form has helped man to
 (a) do such things as building shelter and make carts, boats, etc.
 (b) make bombs and missiles
 (c) build factories using machinery
 (d) make planes
16. Nature now needs to be protected from man because

- (a) nature has become weak
- (b) man is rapidly destroying Nature
- (c) man is cruel to animals
- (d) man has become irrational

17. Forests are being destroyed in order to
- (a) provide land for agriculture
 - (b) provide wood for fuel
 - (c) kill dangerous animals
 - (d) provide necessities as well as needless comforts and pleasures
18. The evil effect of destroying Nature instead of using it is seen in
- (a) the fall in production of our factories
 - (b) the fall in our standard of living
 - (c) the unfavourable changes in climate
 - (d) frequent occurrence of epidemics
19. Climatic changes and soil erosion are results of
- (a) scientific developments
 - (b) nuclear explosion
 - (c) natural calamity
 - (d) deforestation

PASSAGE – 6

According to the civil laws of most countries obedience is no longer the duty of a wife; every woman has the political right to vote; but these liberties remain theoretical as long as she does not have economic freedom. A woman supported by a man is not liberated from the male. It is through gainful employment that woman has travelled most of the distance that separated her from the male; and nothing else can guarantee her liberty in practice. I once heard a maidservant declare, while cleaning the stone floor of a hotel lobby, "I never asked anybody for anything; I succeeded all by myself." She was as proud of her self-sufficiency as a Rockefeller, Ford or Birla. However, the mere combination of the right to vote and a job does not mean complete liberation : working, today, is not a liberty. A recent study of women workers in a car factory shows that they would prefer to stay in the home rather than work in the factory. The majority of women do not escape from the traditional feminine world. Their jobs at the factory do not relieve them of housekeeping burdens; they get from neither society nor their husbands, the assistance they need to become in concrete fact the equals of men.

20. Which of the following helps women most to achieve equality with men?
- (a) The right to vote
 - (b) Civil liberties
 - (c) A job
 - (d) Wealthy husbands
21. Why does the writer talk about the maidservant in the hotel lobby?
- (a) The servants of today will one day be freed from their rich masters
 - (b) A servant can become as rich as Rockefeller or Birla
 - (c) Even with a low paid job women can achieve equality
 - (d) Economic independence is necessary for women's liberation.
22. In which paragraph does the writer say that it is revealed that some women would not like to work in the factory?
- (a) In paragraph four
 - (b) In paragraph three
 - (c) In paragraph two
 - (d) In paragraph one
23. "These liberties" in the first paragraph refer to
- (a) The right to vote, not to obey and right to a job
 - (b) The right to vote and not to obey
 - (c) The rights of servants to disobey their master and the right of the master to punish them
 - (d) Women's right to vote and earn money

PASSAGE – 7

During the past three generations the diseases affecting western societies have undergone dramatic changes. Polio, diphtheria, tuberculosis, commonly known as TB, are vanishing; one injection of an antibiotic often cures deadly diseases such as pneumonia or syphilis; and so many mass killers have come under control that two-thirds of all death are now associated with the diseases of old age. Those who die young are more often than not victims of accidents, violence or suicide. These changes in health status are generally equated with the decrease in suffering and attributed to more or better medical care. Almost everyone believes that at least one of his friends would not be alive and well except for the skill of a doctor. But there is in fact no evidence of any direct relationship between this change in the pattern or nature of sicknesses on the one

hand and the so-called progress of medicine on the other hand. These changes are the results of political technological changes. They are not related to the activities that require the preparation and status of doctors or the costly equipment in which doctors take pride. In addition, an increase in the number of new diseases in the last fifteen years are themselves the result for medical intervention. They are doctor-made or iatrogenic.

24. In the western societies, the occurrence of polio, diphtheria and tuberculosis has
(a) increased
(b) completely stopped
(c) decreased
(d) continued without changes
25. More death are now associated with old age than in the past because
(a) iatrogenic diseases are spreading faster now
(b) deadly diseases affecting the young have been well controlled
(c) accidents, violence and suicide that killed many youths in the past are now under control
(d) political and technological changes now take better care of the young than the old
26. The writer probably is arguing for
(a) stopping the practice of western medicines completely
(b) stopping the use of costly equipment and medicines
(c) rethinking about the successes and failures of the western medicines
(d) giving greater attention to new, iatrogenic diseases than to the old diseases such as polio, diphtheria and pneumonia

PASSAGE – 8

Poverty is a complex problem. It is far more than an economical condition. We measure it usually in terms of income but forget that poverty embraces a whole range of circumstances, including lack of access to information and to basic services like nutritional diet, health care and education. It results into a loss of cultural identity and destroys traditional knowledge. Poor people become marginalised and suffer from exploitation and loss of human dignity.

27. Which of the following sentences comes close to the meaning of the sentence,

“Poverty embraces a whole range of circumstances.”

- (a) There are lot of angles to poverty
(b) They are several section in the society which are poor
(c) There are several types of poverty
(d) Poverty is solely an economic issue

28. What way do you think ‘lack of access to information’ affects poor people?
(a) They don’t get information about how to improve their conditions
(b) They didn’t get newspapers to read at all
(c) They can’t go to school and read books
(d) They don’t get information about schemes of getting rich
29. Why do you think ‘cultural identify’ is important?
(a) A sense of cultural identify gives people self-respect and confidence
(b) Cultural identify defines the character of poor people
(c) It is important to have cultural identify to get jobs
(d) It is useful to have cultural identity because it brings your success
30. Which of the following sentences comes closest to the sentence ‘Poor people become marginalised’?
(a) They are not given any benefit of any government schemes
(b) They are ignored by the rich people
(c) They are the most ignored elements of the society
(d) They are the most disposed elements of the society
31. What do you think is the tone of the passage?
(a) Objective but querulous
(b) Descriptive and impassioned
(c) Argumentative and critical
(d) Objective and critical

[CDS 2018 (I)]

PASSAGE – 9

Over-population is the most pressing of India’s numerous and multi-faceted problems. In fact it has caused equally complex problems such as poverty, under-nourishment, unemployment and excessive fragmentation of land. Indisputably, this country has been facing a population explosion of crisis dimensions. It has

largely diluted the fruits of the remarkable economic progress that the nation has made during the last four decades or so. The entire battle against poverty is thwarted by the rapid increase in the population. The tragedy is that while over-population accentuates poverty, the country's stark poverty itself is in many areas a major cause of over-population.

32. What is the irony behind the over-population of India?
 (a) Over-population gives birth to poverty, which (poverty) itself is the cause of over-population
 (b) Under nourishment and unemployment are outcomes of flawed economic progress
 (c) Fragmentation of land is leading to over-population
 (d) Fruits of the remarkable economic progress are trickling down to the poor
33. What is the general tone of the passage?
 (a) funny/humorous (b) sombre
 (c) didactic (d) tragic
34. What, in the author's view, severely affects the economic growth of our country?
 (a) poverty (b) illiteracy
 (c) over-population (d) None of the above
35. What, according to the author, is the biggest reason behind over-population?
 (a) under-nourishment
 (b) unemployment
 (c) excessive fragmentation of land
 (d) poverty
36. "It has largely diluted the fruits of the remarkable economic progress". Find antonym of the underlined word
 (a) coalesced (b) compounded
 (c) cheapened (d) consolidated

PASSAGE - 10

To eat and not be eaten – that's the imperative of a caterpillar's existence. The leaf roller reduces its risks of being picked off by predators by silking together a temporary shelter in which to feed and rest. Adopting a different line of defense, the jelly slug extrudes a sticky translucent coating that may foul the mouthparts of marauding ants. For its part, the aquatic larva, by its watery element, fashions a portable hideout from fragments of aquatic leaves. Cutting a serpentine trail as it feeds on tender young

leaves, the minute citrus leaf miner spends its entire larval life inside its host plant, thus keeping its appetizing body safely under wraps.

37. Which varieties of caterpillars 'build' shelters to protect themselves?
 (a) Leaf roller and aquatic larva
 (b) Leaf roller and jelly slug
 (c) Jelly slug and aquatic larva
 (d) Jelly slug and citrus leaf miner
38. Which one of the following caterpillars produces a sticky covering?
 (a) Leaf roller (b) Jelly slug
 (c) Aquatic larva (d) Citrus leaf miner
39. Which one of the following pairs of words in the passage describes enemies of the caterpillar?
 (a) Serpentine and host
 (b) Predator and marauding
 (c) Serpentine and marauding
 (d) Predator and host
40. Which one of the following makes itself unpalatable?
 (a) Leaf roller (b) Jelly slug
 (c) Aquatic larva (d) Leaf miner
41. The main idea of the passage is that caterpillars
 (a) like to eat a lot
 (b) have to protect themselves while feeding
 (c) are good to eat
 (d) are not good to eat

PASSAGE - 11

I have always opposed the idea of dividing the world into the Orient and the Occident. It is, however, the tremendous industrial growth that has made the West what it is. I think the difference, say, between India and Europe in the 12th or 13th century would not have been very great. Differences have been intensified by this process of industrialization which has promoted material wellbeing tremendously and which is destroying the life of the mind, which is in a process of deterioration, chiefly because the environment that has been created by it does not give time or opportunity to individuals to think. If the life of the mind is not encouraged, then inevitably civilization collapses.

42. The words "the Orient and the Occident" mean

- (a) the West and the East respectively
- (b) the East and the West respectively
- (c) the North and the South respectively
- (d) the South and the North respectively

43. The author believes that the difference between India and Europe in the 12th or 13th century was not very great because
- (a) Indians and Europeans mixed freely
 - (b) Indians imitated the European way of living
 - (c) Europeans imitated the Indian way of living
 - (d) Industrialization had not yet taken place
44. In the opinion of the author, Industrialization is
- (a) an absolute blessing
 - (b) an absolute curse
 - (c) neither a blessing nor a curse
 - (d) more of a curse than a blessing
45. The author says that the mental life of the world is in a process of deterioration because the modern generation is
- (a) endowed with low mental powers
 - (b) too lazy to exert its mental powers
 - (c) taught that physical activities are more important than mental
 - (d) brought up in an environment unfavourable to the growth of the mental life
46. The title that best expresses the central idea of the passage is
- (a) difference between the Occident and the Orient
 - (b) impact of Industrialization on our civilization
 - (c) advantages of Industrialization
 - (d) disadvantages of Industrialization

PASSAGE - 12

In Delhi, it was forbidden by the law, at one time, to take a Dog into a public vehicle. One day a lady, accompanied by a pet dog, entered a bus. Wishing to evade the law, she placed her tiny dog in her dress pocket. It so happened that the person next to this lady was a pick-pocket; and during the journey the carefully placed his hand into her pocket in search of her purse. Great was the horror to find instead a pair of sharp teeth inserted into his fingers. His exclamation of pain and surprise drew the attention of other passengers to him.

47. Once the law in Delhi did not permit the people to
- (a) carry dogs into private vehicles
 - (b) board a bus without ticket
 - (c) carry dogs into a public vehicle
 - (d) carry animals with them
48. In order to evade the law, the lady
- (a) hid the dogs under the seat
 - (b) got off the bus
 - (c) gave the dog to a fellow passenger
 - (d) put the dog in her pocket
49. The pick-pocket travelling with the lady
- (a) reported the matter to the conductor
 - (b) put his hand in her pocket
 - (c) took out the dog
 - (d) asked the lady to get off
50. Which one of the following correctly expresses the meaning of "wishing to evade the law"?
- (a) Wish to avoid following the law
 - (b) Desire to follow the law blindly
 - (c) Reluctance to break the law
 - (d) Wish to change the law
51. Why did the pick-pocket exclaim with pain?
- (a) He was hit by the lady
 - (b) He was caught by the fellow-passengers
 - (c) He was bitten by the dog
 - (d) He fell off the bus

[CDS 2018 (II)]

PASSAGE - 13

Daily consumption of a certain form of curumin improved memory and mood in people with mild, are-related memory loss. The research examined the effects of an easily absorbed curcumin supplement on memory performance in people without dementia, as well as curcumin's potential impact on the microscopic plaques and tangled in the brains of people with alzhemier's disease. Found in turmeric, curcumin has previously been shown to have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties in laboratory students. It has also been suggested as a possible reason that senior citizens in India, where curcumin is a dietary staple, have a lower prevalence of Alzheimer's disease and better cognitive performance.

52. Which of the following statements are true?

1. Senior citizens in India have high level of Alzheimer's disease because of consumption of turmeric
 2. Senior citizens in India do not have high prevalence of Alzheimer's because of consumption of turmeric.
 3. Consumption of turmeric enhances cognitive performance
 4. Curcumin is an antioxidant
 Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 2, 3 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 4
 (c) 1 and 4 only (d) 1 and 3 only

53. Curcumin has positive effect on people
 (a) Without dementia
 (b) With Alzheimer's disease
 (c) Without dementia and with Alzheimer's disease
 (d) With dementia and with Alzheimer's disease
54. Which word in the passage means 'earlier'?
 (a) Performance (b) Absorbed
 (c) Properties (d) Previously
55. Eating turmeric
 (a) Will reduce the chance of getting Alzheimer's disease
 (b) Will increase curcumin
 (c) Will enhance dementia
 (d) Will reduce chance of getting cancer
56. _____ of a disease in a region depends on the food habits too.
 (a) Dominance (b) Prevalence
 (c) Affection (d) Death

PASSAGE - 614

Mr. Rowland Hill, when a young man, was walking through the Lake district, when he one day saw the postman deliver a letter to a woman at a cottage door. The woman turned it over and examined it, and then returned it, saying she could not pay the postage, which was a shilling. Hearing that the letter was from her brother, Mr. Hill paid the postage, in spite of the manifest unwillingness of the woman. As soon as the postman was out of sight, she showed Mr. Hill how his money had been wasted, as far as she was concerned. The sheet was blank. There was an agreement between her brother and herself that as long as all went well with him, he should send a blank sheet in this way once a quarter, and she thus tiding of him without expense of postage.

57. The story uses irony as a technique because:

- (a) The woman returned her own brother's letter without opening it.
 (b) The woman broke the agreement of receiving blank letters to convey well being of her brother
 (c) Mr. Hill accepted the letter addressed to the woman
 (d) In the modern times a brother has no time to write a letter to his own sister.

58. The woman returned the letter to the postman because

- (a) She could not pay the postage
 (b) The letter was not addressed to her
 (c) She already knew the contents of the letter
 (d) She hated the person who wrote the letter

59. Mr. Hill paid the postage because

- (a) The letter was from her brother
 (b) The woman was his relative
 (c) The letter was addressed to him
 (d) He wanted to be kind to her

60. The envelope contained

- (a) A currency note
 (b) Two written sheets
 (c) No sheet at all
 (d) A blank sheet

61. The woman and her brother had agreed that:

- (a) The letter with no postage meant good news
 (b) The blank sheet meant being well
 (c) The blank sheet meant bad news
 (d) The letter with no postage meant unimportant news

PASSAGE - 15

In good many cases unnecessary timidity makes the trouble worse than it needs to be. Public opinion is always more tyrannical towards those who obviously fear it than towards those who feel indifferent to it. A dog will bark more loudly and bite more easily when people are afraid of it than when they treat him with contempt, and human herd has something of this same characteristic. If you show that you are afraid of them, you give promise of good hunting, whereas if you show indifference, they begin to doubt their own power and, therefore, tend to let you alone.

62. If we are afraid of public opinion, the attitude of the people towards us is:
(a) Sympathetic (b) Indifferent
(c) Admiration (d) Ruthless
63. The statement, 'A dog will bark more loudly and bite more easily when people are afraid of him, than when they treat him with contempt.....'implies that:
(a) Barking dogs seldom bite
(b) We should not be afraid of dogs
(c) If we are afraid of others, they will leave us along
(d) If we are afraid of people, they will try to scare us more.
64. The author compares men with dogs in respect of:
(a) Attacking others without any reason
(b) Attacking others when they are weak
(c) Barking and biting
(d) Faithfulness to the master
65. '.....you give promise of good hunting' means:
(a) You are vulnerable
(b) You are challenging
(c) You are indomitable
(d) You are fondled

PASSAGE - 16

We live in a curious age. We are offered glimpses of a world civilization slowly emerging, the example, the UN special agencies dedicated to health and education. But along with these are sights and sounds that suggest that the whole civilization is rapidly being destroyed. Two official policies clash, and instantly embassies are attacked by howling mobs of students, at once defying law, custom and usage. And that this may not be merely so many hot-headed lads escaping all control, and may itself be part of the policy of the political parties, that is, mob antics as additional propaganda to deceive world opinion, makes the situation even worse. Parties have always been dishonest, but now it seems as if power-mania is ready to destroy those civilities that make international relations possible. There is something even worse. What inspires these students to burn cars and books is not their political enthusiasm but a frenzied delight in destruction, an urge towards violent demolition.

66. The author calls our age curious because

- (a) It is an age of science and scientists are curious by nature
(b) It is witnessing the emergence of a world civilization
(c) It is witnessing incidents that threaten to shake the very foundations of civilization
(d) It is an age of contradictions consisting of constructive and destructive activities.

67. It is deplorable to witness mob attacks on embassies following a clash of policies of two official policy makers because:
(a) Students should not take part in politics, but should concentrate on their studies.
(b) They may result in the loss of lives of young and promising students.
(c) They are overlooked by the policy planners themselves
(d) They are indicative of the complete failure of the government in controlling the rebellious students
68. One aspect of the mob indulging in violence and arson is that they:
(a) Destroy very costly things like vehicles
(b) Destroy very valuable artifacts and books
(c) Get a mad delight in destruction for the sake of destruction only
(d) Are motivated by certain political ideology to resort to destruction
69. In the passage the word 'demolition' has the meaning as the word
(a) Defying (b) Antics
(c) Destruction (d) Urge

[CDS 2019 (I)]

PASSAGE - 17

From 1600 to 1757 the East India Company's role in India was that of a trading corporation which brought goods or precious metals into India and exchanged them for Indian goods like textiles and spices, which it sold abroad. Its profit came primarily from the sale of Indian goods abroad. Naturally, it tried constantly to open new markets for Indian goods in Britain and other countries. Thereby, it increased the export of Indian manufacturers, and thus encouraged their production. This is the reason why Indian rulers tolerated and even encouraged the establishment of the Company's factories in India. But, from the very beginning, the British manufacturers were jealous of the popularity that Indian textiles enjoyed in Britain. All of a sudden,

dress fashions changed and light cotton textiles began to replace the coarse woollens of the English. Before, the author of the famous novel, Robinson Crusoe, complained that Indian cloth had “crept into our houses, our closets and bed chambers; curtains, cushions, chairs and at last beds themselves were nothing but calicos or India stuffs”. The British manufactures put pressure on their Government to restrict and prohibit the sale of Indian goods in England. By 1720, laws had been passed forbidding the wear or use of printed or dyed cotton cloth. In 1760 a lady had to pay a fine of 200 for possessing an imported handkerchief! Moreover, heavy duties were imposed on the import of plain cloth. Other European countries, except Holland, also either prohibited the import of Indian cloth or imposed heavy import duties. In spite of these laws, however, Indian silk and cotton textiles still held their own foreign markets, until the middle of the eighteenth century when the English textile industry began to develop on the basis of new and advanced technology.

- 70.** The East India Company was encouraging the export of Indian manufacturers because:
- It was a philanthropic trading corporation
 - It wanted Indian manufacturers to prosper in trade and commerce.
 - It profited from the sale of Indian goods in foreign markets.
 - I feared Indian Kings who would not permit them trade in India.
- 71.** The people of England used Indian cloths because
- They loved foreign and imported clothes
 - The Indian textile was light cotton
 - The Indian cloths were cheaper
 - The Indian clothes could be easily transported.
- 72.** What did the British manufacturer do to compete with the Indian manufacturers?
- They pressurized the government to levy heavy duties on export of Indian clothes
 - They pressurized the government to levy heavy duties on import of India clothes.
 - they requested people to change their fashion preferences
 - They lowered the prices of the Britain made textile.

- 73.** Which source is cited by the author to argue that Indian textile was in huge demand in 18th century England?
- The archival source
 - The scientific source
 - The journalistic source
 - The literary source
- 74.** “New and advanced technology” in the paragraph refers to:
- The French Revolution
 - The Glorious Revolution of England
 - The Industrial Revolution
 - The beginning of colonialism

PASSAGE – 18

Zimbabwe’s prolonged political crisis reached the boiling point earlier this month when President Robert Mugabe dismissed the Vice-President, Emmerson Mnangagwa. A battle to succeed the 93-year old liberation hero-turned President had already been brewing within the ruling Zimbabwe African National Union-Patriotic Front (Zanu-PF), with the old guard backing Mr. Mnangagwa, himself a freedom fighter, and ‘Generation 40’, a grouping of younger leaders supporting Mr. Mugabe’s 52-years old wife, Grace. Ms. Mugabe, known for her extravagant lifestyle and interfering ways, has been vocal in recent months about her political ambitions. Mr. Mugabe was seen to have endorsed her when on November 6 he dismissed Mr. Mnangagwa. But Mr. Mugabe, who has ruled Zimbabwe since its independence in 1980, erred on two counts: he underestimated the deep connections Mr. Mnangagwa has within the establishment and overestimated his own power in a system he had helped shape. In the good old days. Mr. Mugabe was able to rule with an iron grip. But those days are gone. Age and health problems have weakened his hold on power, while there is a groundswell of anger among the public over economic mismanagement. So when he turned against a man long seen by the establishment as his successor. Mr. Mugabe left little doubt that he was acting from a position of political weakness. This gave the security forces the confidence to turn against him and make it clear they didn’t want to Mugabe dynasty. The military doesn’t want to call its action a coup d’état, for obvious reasons. A coup would attract international condemnation,

even sanctions. But it is certain that the army chief, Gen. Constantino Chiwenga, is in charge. His plan, as it emerges, is to force Mr. Mugabe to resign and install a transitional government, perhaps under Mr. Mnangagwa, until elections are held.

75. In the paragraph, who has been called liberation hero?
(a) Constantino Chiwenga
(b) Emmerson Mnangagwa
(c) Robert Mugabe
(d) Army Chief
76. Mrs. Mugabe is supported by
(a) Mr. Mnangagwa (b) Mr. Mugabe
(c) Generation 40 (d) Zanu-PF
77. Mr. Mugabe's political weakness became apparent when
(a) he endorsed his wife
(b) he turned against the army
(c) he suffered from health issues
(d) he dismissed Mr. Mnangagwa
78. The security forces of Zimbabwe staged a coup against the President because
(a) They wanted Mrs. Mugabe as the President
(b) They were aware of Mugabe's failing wealth
(c) They disliked Mugabe's extravagant lifestyle
(d) They did not want to Mugabe dynasty
79. Why does the military not want to call it a coup d'état?
(a) Because coup is immoral
(b) Because coup is illegal
(c) Because coup would lead to international censure and sanctions
(d) Because it would make the public revolt.

PASSAGE - 19

Over-eating is one of the most wonderful practices among those who think that they can afford it. In fact, authorities say that nearly all who can get as much as they desire, over eat to their disadvantage. This class of people could save a great more food than they can save by missing one meal per week and at the same time they could improve their health. A heavy meal at night, the so-called "dinner", is the fashion with many and often is taken shortly before retiring. It is unnecessary and could be forgone, not only once a week but daily without loss of strength. From three to five

hours are needed to digest food. While sleeping, this food not being required to give energy for work, is in many cases converted into excess fat, giving rise to over weight. The evening meal should be light, taken three or four hours before retiring. This prevents over eating, conserves energy and reduces the cost of food.

80. Why should those who over-eat refrain from doing so?
(a) Because over-eating leads to loss of wealth
(b) Because over-eating is bad for health
(c) Because over-eating conserves food
(d) Because over-eating is immoral and unhealthy
81. Over-eating is more prevalent among
(a) the rich (b) the poor
(c) everybody (d) the bourgeoisie
82. The writer is asking the renders
(a) to skip the heavy dinner and take light evening meal instead
(b) to stop eating anything at night
(c) to take food only during the day
(d) to eat food before the sunset
83. What is the most appropriate time for having evening meal?
(a) An hour after the sunset
(b) Three or four hours before sleeping
(c) Before the sunset
(d) Just before sleeping
84. According to the passage, how many times a day should we have food?
(a) three times
(b) two times
(c) Once
(d) Has not been specified
85. According to the passage, people over eat.
(a) Because they can afford to
(b) Because they are hungry
(c) Because they have to work more
(d) Because they have to conserve energy

PASSAGE - 20

Much has been said of the common ground of religious unity. I am not going just now to venture my own theory. But if anyone here hopes that this unity will come by the triumph of any of the religions and the destruction of the others, to him I say,

"Brother, yours is an impossible hope". Do I wish what the Christian would become Hindu? God forbid. Do I wish that the Hindu or Buddhist would become Christian? God forbid.

The seed is put in the ground, and earth and air and water are placed around it. Does the seed become the earth, or the air, or the water? No. It becomes a plant. It develops after the law of its own growth, assimilates the air, the earth, and the water, converts them into plant substance, and grows into a plant.

Similar is the case with religion. The Christian is not to become a Hindu or a Buddhist, nor a Hindu or a Buddhist to become a Christian. But each must assimilate the spirit of the others and yet preserve his individuality and grow according to his own law of growth.

If the Parliament of Religions has shown anything to the world, it is this: it has proved to the world that holiness, purity and charity are not the exclusive possessions of any church in the world, and that every system has produced men and women of the most exalted character. In the face of this evidence, if anybody dreams of the exclusive survival of his own religion and the destruction of the others, I pity him from the bottom of my heart, and point out to him that upon the banner of every religion will soon be written in spite of resistance: "help and not fight," "Assimilation and not Destruction," "Harmony and Peace and not Dissension."

- 86.** According to the author of the passage, people should
- change their religious
 - follow their religions and persuade others to follow it
 - follow their own religions and respect other religions.
 - disrespect other religions
- 87.** The Parliament of Religions is:
- a Christian organization
 - a Buddhist organization
 - a Hindu organization
 - a platform for discussion about every religion of the world.
- 88.** What does the author think about those who dream about the exclusive survival of their own religions and the destruction of the others?

- he hates them
- he desires to imprison them
- he pities them
- he praises them

- 89.** According to the passage, what is "impossible hope"?

- One day, all the people of the world will follow only one religion
- One day, there will be no religion
- Purity and charity are the exclusive possessions
- Banner of every religion will soon be written

[CDS 2019 (II)]

PASSAGE - 21

Mankind's experience of various evolutionary changes from primitive times to the present day has been extensive and varied. However, man's problems were never before as complicated as they seem to be today. Man's economic activity centres primarily around production. Labour is said to be the primary factor of production; its role, therefore, has been given a lot of importance. It should be useful to have an overall view of the economic history of man—from the nomadic times to the modern factory system—and study its relevance to the various labour problems of today.

Initially, man passed through 'the hunting and fishing stage'. During this period, his basic needs were adequately met by Nature. Wild animals, birds and fruits satisfied his hunger, and his thirst was quenched by the waters of springs and rivers. Caves gave him shelter and barks of trees were used as clothing. During this stage of man's progress labour problems did not exist because of the absence of any economic, political and social systems.

Then came 'the pastoral stage'. Which was marked by a certain amount of economic activity. The nomadic and migratory nature of man persisted, and, together with his goats and cattle, he moved on to fresh pastures and meadows. Some conflicts would sometimes take place among herd-owners, for, during this period, the institution of nominal private property ownership was not known.

This stage paves the way for 'the agriculture stage,' during which the class system began to develop. There was a small artisan class mostly self-employed; and there were also

landed proprietors or Zamindars as well as slaves. Thus, arose the feudal system. During the fourth stage of these developments, 'the handicrafts stage', a number of social and economic changes took place which marked the beginning of the labour problem in the world. The self-sufficient economy of the village underwent a drastic change. The community of traders and merchants emerged.

90. Humanty's evolution from primitive stage to the present has been
 (a) static and smooth
 (b) huge and diversified
 (c) always violent
 (d) always peaceful
91. "man's problems were never before as complicated as they seem to be today" means
 (a) the present times are the best times of humanity
 (b) the present times are the crucial period of humanity
 (c) the present times pose much more challenges to humans than the previous times
 (d) the present times provide much more facilities than the previous times.
92. Why does the author say that labour problems did not exist during 'the hunting and fishing stage'?
 (a) there was no nation existing at that time
 (b) there were no economic, political and social systems
 (c) there was no capitalism and market
 (d) there was no labour law
93. "The pastoral stage was marked by a certain amount of economic activity." How?
 (a) humans started migrating and held goat-herds
 (b) human started owning land
 (c) conflict started as humans owned goats
 (d) humans started doing agriculture
94. Which word in the passage means 'surfaced'?
 (a) quenched (b) emerged
 (c) nomadic (d) adequately

PASSAGE - 22

Ever since independence, land reforms have been a major instrument of State Policy to promote both equity and agricultural

investment. Unfortunately, progress on land reforms has been slow, reflecting the resilience of structures of power that gave rise to the problem in the first place.

The main instrument for realizing more equitable distribution of land is the land ceiling laws. These laws were enacted by several States during the late 1950s and 1960s, and the early 1970s saw more stringent amendments in the laws to plug loopholes in the earlier laws. But the record of implementation has not been satisfactory. Around 3 million hectares of land has been declared surplus so far, which is hardly 2 percent of net sown area in India. About 30 percent of this land has not yet been distributed as it is caught up in the litigations. Besides, a number of Benami and clandestine transactions have resulted in illegal possession of significant amounts of land above ceiling limits. There are widespread reports of allotment of inferior, unproductive, barren and wasteland to landless household, many of whom have been forced to sell it off, in the absence of resource to make it productive. In many instances, lands allotted to the rural poor under the ceiling laws are not in their possession. In some cases, Pattas were issued to the beneficiaries. But possession of land shown in the pattas was not given, or corresponding changes were not made in the record of right.

The balance of power in rural India is so heavily weighed against the landless and the poor that implementing land ceiling laws is difficult. It is clear that without massive mobilization of the rural poor and depending on democratic governance in rural India, very little can be achieved in this direction.

Although half of India's population continues to depend on agriculture as its primary source of livelihood, 83 percent of farmers operated holdings of less than 2 hectares in size, and the average holding size is only 1.23 hectares. This is often in fragments and unirrigated. There are also those who are entirely landless, although agriculture is their main source of livelihood. They have inadequate financial resources to purchase and often depends on leasing in small plots, on insecure terms, for short periods, sometimes only for one season. Hence, many face insecurity of tenure and the growing threat of land

- alienation and pressure from urbanization, industrialization, and powerful interest.
- 95.** Why does the land reform prove to be slow?
 (a) because of the disparity in power structure
 (b) because of the power of the government
 (c) because State have different laws
 (d) because of the of land in the country
- 96.** Which of the following statement is/are correct?
 1. Land ceiling laws have proved to be unsatisfactory
 2. The democratic structure of the government cannot provide solution to the problem of land reforms
 3. The owners of land have abundant natural resources.
 4. Identified land for distribution has not been distributed due to court cases against it.
 Select the correct answer using the code given below.
 (a) 1 and 4 (b) 1 only
 (c) 3 and 4 (d) 2 and 4
- 97.** One of the reasons of selling off the lands by the allottee is that the land were
 (a) unproductive and barren
 (b) salty, not getting water
 (c) fertile, but uncultivable
 (d) with the powerful people
- 98.** Which word/group of words in the passage means 'lawsuit'?
 (a) Amendments (b) Litigation
 (c) Illegal possession (d) Fragments
- 99.** According to the author, what is the primary source of livelihood of majority of India's population?
 (a) Industry (b) Forest
 (c) Agriculture (d) None
- 100.** "There are also those who are entirely landless, although agriculture is their main source of livelihood" means
 (a) they do not have money to buy lands
 (b) they have sold off their lands to others
 (c) most of them are agriculture labourers
 (d) they are migrant labourers from other places

PASSAGE - 23

Despite downsizings, workers' overall job satisfaction actually improved between 1988 and 1994. Some reasons given were

improved work flow, better cooperation between departments, and increased fairness in supervision. Many firms today rely on attitude surveys to monitor how employees feel about working in their firms. The use of employee attitude surveys had grown since 1994 when the National Industrial Conference Board "had difficulty finding fifth companies that had conducted opinion surveys". Today, most companies are aware of the need for employees' anonymity, the impact of both the design of the questions and their sequence, the importance of effective communication, including knowing the purpose of the survey before it is taken and getting feedback to the employees after it is completed. Computerization of surveys can provide anonymity, if there is no audit trail to the user, especially for short answers that are entered rather than written or typed on an identifiable machine.

Survey software packages are available that generate questions for a number of standard topics and can be customized by modifying existing question or by adding questions. If the survey is computerized, reports can be generated with ease to provide snapshots of a given period of time, trend analysis, and breakdowns according to various demographics. You may be interested in responses by age, sex, job categories, departments, division, functions of geography.

The survey can be conducted by placing microcomputers in several locations convenient for employees' use. Employees are advised where the computers will be, for how long, and when the data will be collected (for instance, daily at 5:00 pm. For three weeks). The screens should not be viewable to supervisors or passers-by. While there may be some risk that employees will take the survey more than once, there are comparable risks with other methods too.

Managers may be interested in knowing how they are perceived by their peers and subordinates. Packages are available that can be customized, which allow the manager to complete a self-assessment tool used to compare self-perceptions to the anonymous opinions of others. This comparison may assist in the development of a more effective manager.

- 101.** Which one of the following is not the reason for improved job satisfaction of employees?
 (a) Improved work flow
 (b) Better cooperation between departments
 (c) Supervisors' fairness
 (d) Increased remuneration
- 102.** Companies feel that it is necessary to
 (a) maintain anonymity of the employees and to have effective design and sequence of questions and effective communication
 (b) maintain the fairness of the managers to be part of the survey
 (c) conduct survey from their employees
 (d) maintain anonymity of the employees and not to have effective design and sequence of questions and effective communication
- 103.** One major benefit of using survey software packages is:
 (a) reports can be generated easily
 (b) privacy of a person is exposed to the supervisors
 (c) employees would like to take up the test on computer
 (d) employer can get to know the information immediately.
- 104.** Which word in the passage means 'tendency'?
 (a) Trend (b) Breakdowns
 (c) Convenient (d) Perceptions
- 105.** "The screens should not be viewable to supervisors or passers-by." Why?
 (a) To maintain the secrecy of a person
 (b) The main problem is to enable everyone to participate
 (c) The manager has to be fair enough
 (d) To maintain the problems faced by women in job market
- 106.** What does the word 'customized' mean here?
 (a) Adapted (b) Take as it is
 (c) Fixed (d) Mass produced

[CDS 2020 (I)]

PASSAGE - 24

Not all agricultural societies become civilizations, but no civilization can become one without passing through the stage of agriculture. This is because at some stage in the development of agriculture, as

productivity improves, not all people would need to be engaged in producing or procuring food. A significant number of people could be freed up to pursue other activities such as building walls or monuments for new cities; making new tools, weapons and jewellery; organizing long distance trade, creating new artistic masterpieces; coming up with new inventions; keeping accounts; and perhaps constructing new public infrastructure such as irrigation canals that further improve the productivity of agriculture, thus realizing even more people to do new things.

This can happen, of course, only if a society that has transitioned to high productivity agriculture has also some stage in its evolution, found a way to channel the bonanza of free time into other work fruitfully. In the ancient world, this often involved creating new ideologies and new hierarchies or power structures to coerce or otherwise convince large groups of people to devote their time to the new tasks for very little reward.

- 107.** Which one of the following statements is true according to the author?
 (a) Agriculture has always been part of all civilizations.
 (b) Not all civilization have undergone the processes or agriculture
 (c) Agriculture gave birth to new civilization
 (d) Communities discontinued agriculture to become civilizations.
- 108.** A significant number of people were sent to carry out other work from agriculture because
 (a) There were insufficient agricultural products
 (b) People were needed to build monuments, weapons, jewellery, etc.
 (c) There were sufficient agricultural products
 (d) This enabled the development of civilization.
- 109.** What kind of agriculture based societies would emerge as civilizations?
 (a) Societies which achieved high productivity in agriculture had the opportunity to find time for other work
 (b) Societies which depended on agriculture completely moved to other fruitful work so as to move to many places.

- (c) Societies which transitioned from one stage of agriculture to another.
(d) Societies which could not do agriculture for lack of resources moved to other work.

- 110.** People as groups were convinced to do new work through
(a) Reward, force and community persuasions.
(b) Ideologies, hierarchies and power structure
(c) Excessive agricultural products
(d) Very high rewards
- 111.** Which word in the passage means 'changeover'?
(a) Transitioned (b) Channel
(c) Coerce (d) Hierarchies

PASSAGE – 25

Then we pick up a newspaper, a book, or an article we come to our task with certain perceptions and predispositions. We expect to find a specific piece of information or be presented with an argument or an analysis of something, say, the livelihood of recession in the next six months or the reason why children can't read. We probably know a little about the book or article we are reaching even before we start. There was, after all, some reason why we chose to read one piece of writing rather than another.

Our expectations and predispositions may, however, blind us to what the article and its author is actually saying. If, for example, we are used to disagreeing with the author, we may see only what we expect to see and not what is actually there. Day after day in our routine pattern of life we expose ourselves to the same newspaper, the same organize, even books by authors with the same perspectives. In order to reflect on our reading habits and improve our skills we need to break out of this routine, step back and look at what we are doing when we read.

- 112.** According to the author, which one of the following statements is not true?
(a) Reader's preconceptions influence their reading
(b) Readers have expectations when they read an article or a book.
(c) Readers look for specific information in any of their readings.

- (d) Readers assume that everything they read will have new information.

- 113.** Our expectations and predispositions may, however, blind us because:
(a) We may not get the actual ideas of the author
(b) We will get the actual ideas of the author
(c) We may disagree with the author.
(d) We will agree with all the ideas of the author
- 114.** One of the ways to improve our reading habits is to:
(a) Break the routine by changing the time of reading
(b) Change the types of topics we read
(c) Break the routine of reading the same newspaper
(d) Stop reading for some time and then restart reading
- 115.** Which quality does the author here advocate, to be a good reader?
(a) Being objective to the ideas of the author
(b) Having preconceptions and predispositions
(c) Having contrivous routines
(d) Disagreeing with the author
- 116.** Which word in the passage means 'viewpoints'?
(a) Preconceptions (b) Predispositions
(c) Pattern (d) Perspectives

[CDS 2020 (II)]

PASSAGE – 26

Post colonial cultural analysis has been concerned with the elaboration of theoretical structures that contest the previous dominant western ways of seeing things. A simple analogy would be with feminism, which has involved a comparable kind of project: there was a time when any book you might read, any speech you might hear, any film that you saw, was always told from the point of view of male. The woman was there, but she was always an object, never a subject. From what you would read, or the films you would see, the woman was always the one who was looked at. She was never the observing eye. For centuries it was assumed that women were less intelligent than men and that they did not merit the same degree of education. They were not allowed a vote in the political system. By the

same token, any kind of knowledge developed by women was regarded as non-serious, trivial, gossip or alternatively as knowledge that had been discredited by science, such as superstition or traditional practices of childbirth or healing. All these attitudes were part of a larger system in which women were dominated, exploited, and physically abused by men. Slowly, but increasingly, from the end of 18th century, feminists began to contest this situation. The more they contested it, the more it became increasingly obvious that these attitude extended into the whole of the culture; social relations, politics, law, medicine, the arts, popular and academic knowledge.

- 117.** Post colonialism is
 (a) a contestation of then existing dominant western practices
 (b) a contestation of western practices in colonial states
 (c) a contestation of the superstitious practice
 (d) an approval of indigenous practices
- 118.** What does '...she was always an object, never a subject' mean?
 (a) women were given respect and worshipped
 (b) women were not given any right equal to men
 (c) women were treated at par with men
 (d) women liked to be treated inferior to men
- 119.** Why was 'she never the observing eye'?
 (a) she was beautiful, so she was observed by men
 (b) she liked to be observed by men
 (c) women were assumed to be less intelligent than men
 (d) women were assumed to be more intelligent than men
- 120.** The contestation to dominance of the male resulted in:
 (a) participation of women in social relations, politics, law, medicine, the arts, popular and academic knowledge.
 (b) participation of men in social relations, politics, law, medicine, the arts, popular and academic knowledge.
 (c) participation of women in social movements
 (d) contestations with males in life leading to divorce

- 121.** Which word in the passage is opposite of 'contrast'?

(a) contestations (b) trivial
 (c) discreditable (d) analogy

PASSAGE - 27

How wonderful is the living world! The wide range of the living types is amazing. The extraordinary habitats in which we find living organisms, be it cold mountains, deciduous forests, oceans, fresh water lakes, deserts or hot springs, leave us speechless. The beauty of galloping horse, or migrating bird, the valley of flowers or the attacking shark evokes awe and a deep sense of wonder. The ecological conflict and cooperation among members of a population and among populations of a community or even a molecular traffic inside a cell make us deeply reflect on-what indeed is life? This question has two implicit questions within it. The first is a technical one and seeks answer to what living is an opposed to the non-living, and the second is the philosophical one, and seeks answer to what the purpose of life is:

What is living? When we try to define 'living', we conventionally look for distinctive characteristic exhibited by living organisms. Growth, reproduction, ability to sense environment and mount a suitable response come to our mind immediately as unique features of living organisms. One can add a few features like metabolism, ability to self-replicate, self-organize, interact and emergence to this list.

- 122.** Why are the living types amazing?
 (a) The extraordinary diversity of habitats makes it amazing;
 (b) The living organism are acting as per their interests
 (c) The human thinking makes the living types amazing
 (d) The evolution of life makes it amazing
- 123.** Why does the author say, 'ecological conflict and cooperation'?
 (a) Because living organisms are structured this way
 (b) Because ecological mechanism works with conflict and cooperation

- (c) Because humans want to fight and live together
(d) Because living organisms some times fight and sometimes live together.

- 124.** Which of the following statements is true of the passage?
(a) Meaning of life could be reflected as to what living is as opposed to the non-living and what the purpose of life is:
(b) Meaning of life could be reflected as to how living organisms live and non-living organisms exist
(c) Meaning of life could be reflected on how various living organisms differ
(d) Meaning of life could be reflected on how various living organism differ
- 125.** Distinctive characteristics exhibited by organisms indicate that
(a) They are living organisms
(b) They are non-living organisms
(c) They can be either living organisms or non-living organisms
(d) They know the purpose of life
- 126.** Which word in the passage mean 'unique'?
(a) Common
(b) Characteristics
(c) Distinctive
(d) General

[CDS 2021 (I)]

PASSAGE – 28

Conventional education makes independent thinking extremely difficult. Conformity leads to mediocrity. To be different from the group or to resist environment is not easy and is often risky as long as we worship success. The urge to be successful, which is the pursuit of reward whether in the materials or in the so-called spiritual sphere, the search for inward or outward security, the desire for comfort-this whole process smothers discontent, put an end to spontaneity and breed fear; and fear blocks the intelligent understanding of life. With increasing age, dullness or mind and heart sets in.

In seeking comfort, we generally find a quiet corner in life where there is a minimum of conflict, and then we are afraid to step out of that seclusion. This fear of life, this fear of struggle and of a new experience, skills in us the spirit of adventure; our whose upbringing and education have made us afraid to be different from our neighbor,

afraid to think contrary to the established pattern of society, falsely respectful of authority and tradition.

Fortunately, there are a few who are in earnest, who are willing to examine our human problems without the prejudice of the right or of the left; but in the vast majority of us, there is no real spirit of discontent, or revolt. When we yield uncomprehendingly to environment, any spirit of revolt that may have had died down, and our responsibilities soon put an end to it.

- 127.** Why does conventional education make independent thinking extremely difficult?
(a) It does not encourage disagreement
(b) It does not accept conformity
(c) It is not fact based, but problem based
(d) It is only religious education
- 128.** Worshipping success lead to
(a) Questioning the established practices
(b) Accepting the established practices
(c) Modifying the established practices
(d) Neither accepting nor rejecting the established practice
- 129.** Why do most people want to find a quiet corner in life?
(a) Because they do not like to be in peace
(b) Because they seek pleasure
(c) Because they seek comfort
(d) Because they do not worship success

- 130.** Which word in the passage means 'bias'?
(a) Contrary
(b) Prejudice
(c) Uncomprehendingly
(d) Discontent

- 131.** The word "uncomprehendingly" in the passage means:
(a) Achieve success
(b) Earning money
(c) Without knowing
(d) With complete knowledge

PASSAGE – 29

Noise is a common problem in both urban and rural areas, traffic noise in particular. Trees and shrubs are not only visually attractive but also can make effective noise barriers. Therefore when space permits we have to plant more trees and shrubs in areas where there is noise problem. By doing this

noise can be reduced by six decibels over a distance of 30 metres.

The only thing we have to keep in mind is that the planting should be particularly dense; the trees which have dense foliage and relatively vertical orientation of arrangements should be planted. It will completely screen the source of noise. If there is any gap in barrier it will still allow noise to penetrate. Single layer of trees is worthless as a noise barrier. Due to inter-reflection, multi-rows of trees are more effective. The planted trees must be taller. We can reduce noise level by 1.5 decibels with each additional 3 feet of tree height.

When the opportunity to use trees is restricted a combination of shrubs and tall grass can be used. Instead of tarmac or gravel surfaces soft grass ground cover is preferable. It will absorb noise rather than reflect it. Rows of trees, shrubs, crotons, ground covering plants, climbers and their flowers not only reduce noise and provide a beautiful backyard they also help block wind, provide shade, and absorb traffic pollution.

- 132.** What distance a good number of trees can cover in reducing noise?
 (a) 30 metres (b) 60 metres
 (c) 3 metres (d) 300 metres
- 133.** Trees can reduce noise only when
 (a) Planted in isolation
 (b) Planted with flowering shrubs
 (c) They are planted dense
 (d) Planted with shorter ones
- 134.** 'Single layer of trees is worthless as a noise barrier'. Why?
 (a) Noise can't penetrate easily
 (b) Help in the growth of shrubs
 (c) Noise is sent back to the source
 (d) Noise can penetrate easily
- 135.** Higher the trees
 (a) Higher the noise (b) Lower the noise
 (c) Greater the decibels (d) Thinner the air
- 136.** How do shrubs and tall grass reduce noise?
 (a) They absorb noise
 (b) They reflect noise
 (c) They divert noise
 (d) They are neutral to noise

As to happiness, I am not so sure. Birds. It is true, die of hunger in large numbers during the winter, if they are not birds of passage. But during the summer they do not foresee this catastrophe, or remember how nearly it befell them in the previous winter. With human beings the matter is otherwise. I doubt whether the percentage of birds that will have died of hunger during the present winter (1946-47) is as great as the percentage of human beings that will have died from this cause in India and central Europe during the same period. But every human death by starvation is preceded by long period of anxiety, and surrounded by the corresponding anxiety of neighbors. We suffer not only the evils that actually befall us, but all those that our intelligence tells us we have reason to fear. The curbing of impulses to which we are led by forethought averts physical disaster at the cost of worry, and general lack of joy. I do not think that the learned men of my acquaintance, even when they enjoy a secure income, are as happy as the mice that eat the crumbs from their tables while the erudite gentlemen snooze. In this respect, therefore, I am not convinced that there has been any progress at all.

- 137.** The birds die of hunger in winter because
 (a) they do not move to warmer places
 (b) people do not feed them
 (c) they do not get the food of their choice
 (d) they are too young to get the food
- 138.** The birds do not foresee the catastrophe because they
 (a) cannot predict an accident
 (b) overlook a difficult situation
 (c) cannot expect a sudden disaster
 (d) ignore the problems
- 139.** Human beings cannot be happy because they
 (a) do not get time to enjoy
 (c) worry too much about their work
 (c) are not healthy
 (d) worry too much about future
- 140.** Which one of the following is the antonym of the word 'erudite' in the passage?
 (a) qualified (b) Ill-educated
 (c) logical (d) learned

[CDS 2021 (II)]

Passage-30

- 141.** Which one of the following is the central theme of the passage?
 (a) Life of the birds and the mice
 (b) Starvation in India and central Europe
 (c) Progress of mankind
 (d) Disasters in 1946-47

Passage-31

More than eight months after the national lockdown was announced in late March, urban India is learning to live with the Covid-19 pandemic. In fact, indicating a positive outlook for the future, many survey respondents in a recent survey say they plan to return to pre-lockdown levels of shopping, personal grooming, going to cinemas and socializing as pandemic fears continues to recede.

The survey findings highlight that the suppression of consumer demand because of fears of job losses and salary cuts could be coming to an end. Increasingly, urban Indian are showing increased confidence about the future of the economy. They could be an indicator of the possible 'pent-up demand' that several economists have been talking about—a demand that could be unleashed once a vaccine is developed and distributed, or when there are signs of the pandemic's spread reducing to negligible levels or vanishing totally.

Around 65 percent of respondents said they settled into new routines, or that they saw signs of the situation improving, or they had come to terms with the pandemic and were moving on with their lives. And since the survey was conducted before the news of the successful trials of the Pfizer vaccine fit the corona virus was announced, it is likely that the consumers are now even more positive in their outlook about the future.

- 142.** The general tone of the passage is that of:
 (a) Optimism (b) Pessimism
 (c) Fatalism (d) Defeatism
- 143.** The willingness of consumers to go back to normal lifestyle indicates their
 (a) Causal attitude
 (b) Change of moods
 (c) Desire for future plans
 (d) Sense of economic security
- 144.** Which statement in the passage/phrase indicates that 'Life must go on'?
 (a) They settled into their new routines

- (b) Salary cuts could be coming to an end
 (c) People are moving on with their lives
 (d) 'Pent-up demand'

- 145.** What does the author mean by 'pent-up demand'?
 (a) Desire (suppressed) to spend money once pandemic is controlled
 (b) Economic normalcy of consumers
 (c) Flamboyant shopping by consumers
 (d) Criticism of the public on the pay-cuts

- 146.** What, according to the author, is the reason behind suppression of consumer demands?
 (a) The lack of vaccine till date
 (b) Professional insecurity
 (c) Motive to save up some money
 (d) Careful and calculative attitude of the general public

[CDS 2022 (I)]

Passage-32

All organisms such as plants, animals, microorganisms and human beings as well as the physical surroundings interact with each other and maintain a balance in nature. All the interacting organisms in an area together with the non-living constituents of the environment form an ecosystem. Thus, an ecosystem consists of biotic components comprising living organisms and abiotic components comprising physical factors like temperature, rainfall, wind, soil and minerals.

For example, if you visit a garden you will find different plants, such as grasses, trees; flower-bearing plants like rose, jasmine, sunflower; and animals like frogs, insects and birds. All these living organisms interact with each other and their growth, reproduction and other activities are affected by the abiotic components of the ecosystem. So, a garden is an ecosystem. Other types of ecosystems are forests, ponds and lakes. These are natural ecosystems while gardens and crop-fields are human made ecosystems.

- 147.** The general tone of the passage is
 (a) critical (b) satirical
 (c) analytical (d) informational
- 148.** Which of the following is a non-living constituent of the environment?
 (a) wind (b) Bacteria

(c) Grasses

(d) Frog

- 149.** Abiotic components of the ecosystem refer to
 (a) living organisms
 (b) non-living organisms
 (c) natural surroundings
 (d) physical factors
- 150.** Which of the following is not a natural ecosystem?
 (a) Crop-field (b) Forest
 (c) Pond (d) Lake
- 151.** The word 'constituent' in the passage implies
 (a) constellation (b) consternation
 (c) component (d) constriction

Passage-33

As we discussed food and sang every song we could remember and talked incessantly, we were slowly moving deeper into the Atlantic, and we got the feelings, really, that we belonged there, and that the ships that passed on the horizon were only hurrying strangers. We were actually living on the ocean. We discovered that the birds all seemed to league up at night-time, resting on the water by the hundreds. When we came poking along, we seemed so much a part of the sea that the birds wouldn't move until we were about five yards away. Then they'd flutter off, leaving feathers floating in the water, and settle again a few yards away. The dolphins and porpoises would come up at sunset and move in among us and the birds. They'd come up very lazily under the birds, which would go up on their heels and flap their wings a bit, and then settle right down again. Two whales joined us one evening and played ring around rosie so close to us that they could have reached out an oar and taped one.

We had calculated that we had just enough rations to make England, but the easterly winds caused an agonizing reappraisal. It would have been an interesting experience, running right down like that, but we felt we must not risk other people's lives by making them search for us. We decided to accept rations from the next ship that stopped. Was it a mature decision?

This was also the time when the strain of the voyage really began to tell on us. I wrote in my log: "I have known fear many times in

my life, and indeed I have often striven to develop a situation that provided fear in both boxing and parachuting. I have never known anything like this-cannot be over tomorrow, or for many tomorrows. Somehow it is like being rubbed down with sandpaper. I honestly do not know how many storms there have been now, and each leaves us progressively weaker.'

'Tonight we lie and wait. Nothing could save us if we get into difficulties. No ship could get us off these seas even if it arrived in time. We are completely in God's hands, at the mercy of the weather. All night the wind screams louder and louder, and the sound of the sea grows. We talk of many things-the night train to Scotland, the many things we've done, and slowly we are overtaken by an enormous feeling of humility and a desire to return to try and live a better life. The weather reached a climax at 0300 and then declined rapidly. Thank goodness we could not see the sea.'

- 152.** "We were actually living on the ocean," implies
 (a) they were lomeless
 (b) they were on a long voyage into the Atlantic
 (c) they were without any source of income
 (d) they were fishing deep into the Atlantic for their living.
- 153.** "...the birds all seemed to league up at night-time," implies
 (a) left alone at night time
 (b) isolated at night time
 (c) get together at night time
 (d) stay in groups at night time.
- 154.** What did the author write in his log?
 (a) They faced the worst kind of fear ever experienced
 (b) They were excellent in boxing and parachuting
 (c) They faced the storms bravely
 (d) They starved for food
- 155.** They lost all hope of survival because
 (a) it was freezing cold
 (b) there was no help coming to them
 (c) they were facing a severe sea-storm
 (d) they were frightened by the whales and dolphins.
- 156.** "We are overtaken by an enormous feeling of humility," implies that they

- (a) have lost faith in themselves
- (b) were ready to accept help from the ships around them.
- (c) needed equipment and food to survive.
- (d) have accepted the strength and power of nature with modesty.

Directions : In this section you have three short passages. After each passage, you will find some items based on the passage. Read the passage carefully and answer the items based on it.

Passage-34

China's government announced on April 19 that it had signed a landmark security pact with Solomon Islands evoking concern from Australia and the US. The agreement is the first of its kind that China has agreed with any country, and underlines its ambitions to play a security role in the Pacific. The final version has not been made public. It will pave the way for China to deploy its security forces there. The Solomon Islands can request police and military personnel "to assist in maintaining social order", while China can make ship visits and use its ports for logistics. This will give China's vessels a strategic foothold in the Pacific, in a region close to Australia and Guam, where the US has a naval base. Both countries unsurprisingly expressed concern, with Washington, even dispatching a senior official to the Solomon Islands, who will take up the pact as well as plans to reopen the US Embassy there.

The significance of the pact extends beyond the immediate regional security concerns in the Pacific. The Solomon Islands government agreement does not imply China will build a base there. The pact does, however, relate to a second key pillar of China's avowed "peaceful rise" doctrine, which was, as popularised by "Panchsheel" or the "five principles of peaceful coexistence"- the non-interference in the internal affairs of other countries. The deployment of security forces in a foreign country certainly does not square with that idea. China has already begun to do so elsewhere, albeit on a limited scale. China's past commitments on military and non interference were intended to show the world Beijing would not seek to become a global "hegemon", its favoured term to describe the US.

- 157.** China's objective of signing a security pact with Solomon Islands is:

- [CDS 2022 (II)]**
- (a) to extend its territory
 - (b) to develop Solomon Islands
 - (c) to provide financial aid in enhancing security measures in the Pacific.
 - (d) to contribute in ensuring security in the Pacific.

- 158.** The Pact symbolises China's doctrine of **[CDS 2022 (II)]**
- (a) advancing financial support to countries
 - (b) deployment of security forces wherever needed.
 - (c) advancement of defence technology
 - (d) principles of peaceful coexistence.

- 159.** Which one of the following is implied by Beijing would not seek to become a global hegemon' ? **[CDS 2022 (II)]**
- (a) Beijing would aspire to become a strong ruler.
 - (b) Beijing is ambitious of becoming a Superpower.
 - (c) Beijing is not aspiring to have control over the world.
 - (d) Beijing will play an important role in world politics.

- 160.** What does 'square with that idea' imply in the passage? **[CDS 2022 (II)]**
- (a) Having multiple ideas
 - (b) Not in agreement with the idea
 - (c) Imposing personal views on others
 - (d) Agreeing with the multiple views

- 161.** What does 'strategic foothold' imply in the passage? **[CDS 2022 (II)]**
- (a) Valid entry
 - (b) Planned access
 - (b) Legitimate passage
 - (d) Sanctioned routes

Passage-35

Among the major objectives of the Glasgow Summit was to frame the foundation of an international carbon trading system listed in the Paris Agreement to achieve the target of net zero emissions by 2050. It would enable nations to transfer credits to each other and offset their emission targets. Critics of the trading system, and there are many, say it would give leeway to developed countries and companies that are highly polluting to stave off making deeper cuts in their low emissions by buying credits from poorer

countries at exploitative prices. There are also major differences over whether the new trading system will recognize historical emissions permitted under earlier protocols. Others want rules that permit double credits for the nation funding a particular carbon reducing project, such as the regeneration of forests to act as a carbon sink, and for the country implementing it. A third issue is whether a share of the revenue from such a bilateral trading agreement will go toward the UN's Adaptation Fund. There have also been concerns about the integrity of the accounting system for such credits.

162. What is 'international carbon trading system' here?

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Countries carbon emission by poor countries
- (b) A system of counting carbons every year
- (c) The exchange of carbon credits between nations
- (d) Counting how developed countries evade accountability.

163. What is the third issue being mentioned in the context of 'share of the revenue'?

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) The revenue may not be shared with UN's Adaptation Fund
- (b) Developed countries would take the revenue from bilateral trading agreements.
- (c) Poor countries will have to shoulder the major responsibilities.
- (d) Accounting system will be in the hands of developed countries

164. '.....forests to act as a carbon sink' means

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Forest reduce carbon emission
- (b) Depletion of forest cover adds to carbon emission
- (c) Forests cannot reduce carbon emission
- (d) Forests can improve the environment

165. What is the concern about the integrity of the accounting system?

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Developed countries and companies would not be adhering to the credit system
- (b) Developed countries and companies would be adhering to the credit system

- (c) Poor countries would not be adhering to the credit system on carbon emission
- (d) Poor countries would be adhering to the credit system on carbon emission

166. Which of the following words is nearer to the meaning of the word 'protocol' in the text?

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) final truth
- (b) school of thought
- (c) formal ways of doing something
- (d) meeting the target of 100%

Passage-36

The RBI expects inflation at 6.7 percent in 2022-23. Recent government data also suggests that inflation has become more broad-based. Excluding the volatile components such as food and fuel, core retail inflation was around 7 percent in April with almost all subgroups in the index witnessing elevated inflation. And considering the inflation in the pipeline-the wholesale price index continues to be in double digits-price pressures are unlikely to dissipate in the immediate term. According to analysts, while manufacturing firms have been passing on the rise in input costs, it remains incomplete in the case of the services sector. However, as demand firms up, the pass through is likely to gather traction. This combination of factors suggest that inflation may not fall dramatically as and when commodity prices fall-prices may prove to be a tad sticky on the downside. The RBI's revised quarterly forecasts for inflation also seem to suggest so-inflation has now been projected at 7.5 percent in the first quarter, and 7.4 percent in the second quarter, trending downwards thereafter to 6.2 percent in the third quarter, and 5.8 percent in the fourth quarter.

Implicit in these quarterly inflation forecasts is also the acknowledgment that inflation will likely exceed the upper threshold of the central bank's inflation targeting framework for three consecutive quarters. Considering the risks that the 'unanchoring' of inflation and inflation expectations pose to macroeconomic stability, and the country's growth prospects, the central bank must look beyond its quotidian responsibilities and continue to focus on maintaining price stability, attaching primacy to inflation management.

167. What are the volatile components of inflation?

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) All subgroups in the index
- (b) Components such as food and fuel
- (c) Wholesale price index
- (d) Inflation in the pipeline

168. Why are prices unlikely to abate in the short term?

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Because of inflation in the pipeline
- (b) Because prices once up never come back down
- (c) Because international price situation is volatile
- (d) Because of pressure from subgroups

169. In what context are the words 'pass through' used in the passage?

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) That services sector will increase prices as demand picks up
- (b) That manufacturing sector is bearing the burden of input costs
- (c) That the economy is passing through price pressures
- (d) That inflation will pass through the services sector.

170. Explain the meaning of the word 'quotidian' as used in the passage.

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Existing
- (b) Primary
- (c) Main
- (d) day-to-day

171. Choose the most appropriate option that describes the meaning of the term 'unanchoring' as used in the passage.

[CDS 2022 (II)]

- (a) Stability of inflation that will be securely anchored
- (b) The rising anchor will free inflation
- (c) The disjoint between inflation and its expectations
- (d) Runaway inflation that is out of control

Directions: In this section, you have two short passage. After each passage, you will find some items based on the passage. First, read a passage and answer the items based on it. You are required to select your answer based on the contents of the passage and the opinion of the author only.

[CDS – 2023 (1)]

Passage-37

The third great defect of our civilization is that it does not know what to do with its knowledge. Science has given us powers fit for the gods, yet we use them as small children. For example, we do not know how to manage our machines. Machines were made to be humanity's servants, yet man has grown so dependent on them that they are in a fair way to become his masters. Already most people spend most of their lives looking after and waiting upon machines. And the machines are very stem masters. They must be kept at the right temperature. And if they do not get their meals when they expect them, they grow sulky and refuse to work or burst with rage and blow up and spread ruin and destruction all around. So we have to wait upon them very attentively and do all that we can to keep them in a good temper. Already we find it difficult either to work or play without the machines, and a time may come when they will rule us altogether, just as we rule the animals.

And this brings me to the point at which I asked. "When do we do with all the time which the machines have saved for us, and the new energy they have given us?" On the whole, it must be admitted, we do very little. For the most part, we use our time and energy to make more and better machines which will give us still more time and still more energy, and what are we to do with them? The answer, I think, is that we should try to become more civilized. For the machines themselves, and the power which the machines have given us, are not civilization but aids to civilization. But you will remember that we agreed at the beginning that being civilized meant making and linking beautiful things, thinking freely and living rightly and maintaining justice equally among people. A person has a better chance today to do these things than he/she ever had before; he/she has more time, more energy, less to fear and less to fight against. If he/she will give his/her time and energy which his/her machines have won for him/her to make more beautiful things, to find out more and more about the universe, to remove the cause of quarrels between nations, to discover how to prevent poverty, then I think our civilization would undoubtedly be

the greater as it would be more lasting than it has ever been.

- 172.** The general tone of the passage is:
(a)critical (b) descriptive
(c)demonstrative (d) informational
- 173.** The use of machines has filed to bring us:
(a)spiritual freedom
(b)more leisure and more energy
(c)salvry and destruction
(d)culture and civilization
- 174.** According to the passage, our civilization would be made greater.
(a)if man devotes his time to make more beautiful things
(b)if man looks after and waits upon machines
(c)if machines are made man's servants
(d)if man discovers how to prevent poverty
- 175.** According to the passage, which one of the following descriptions about machines is true?
(a)they already rule us like we rule animals
(b)they wait upon us attentively
(c)they are inexorable masters
(d)They have made man more civilized
- 176.** According to the passage, how do we use the powers bestowed upon us by science?
(a) Judiciously (b) Temperamentally
(c) Divinely (d) Irrationally

Passage-38

Plastic is an essential commodity with multiple uses based on its key qualities of malleability, flexibility, and durability. Plastics are omnipresent in agriculture, fisheries, renewable energy, transport, technology, retail, textiles, personal care products, and all the other sectors and industries that directly or indirectly affect our daily life. Plastic has indeed made our lives more convenient, but it has come at a higher price than we imagined. The plastic pollution overflowing our landfills, clogging waterways, and infiltrating the ocean is primarily made of discarded items and packaging plastic lasts for hundreds of years, slowly disintegrating into smaller and smaller pieces, but never fully degrading. Indeed, one of the key perks of plastic is its longevity. And yet, the plastic packaging of nearly every product we purchase and many plastic products themselves are intended to be discarded

after a single use. Throwaway plastic is an oxymoron, but it has become our sad, increasingly dangerous reality.

Basic pollution should make everyone angry. This is a crisis we can see with the naked eye, day in and day out. Plastic has been found on even the most remote, uninhabited islands, and in the deepest parts of the ocean. Because we can see it, we more keenly aware of it, unlike some other forms of pollution. In 2019, the World Health Organisation (WHO) called for further studies on the impacts of microplastics on human health. An initial study, hampered by a lack of adequate data, concluded microplastics pose no danger at current levels (WHO, 2019). Although the WHO report was inconclusive about the effects of plastic on human health, other studies have linked the chemicals in plastic to negative health outcomes including endocrine disruption (Dabre 2020). Plastic particles have been detected in drinking water and in the food we eat, with a 2019 study commissioned by WWF estimating humans consume about five grams (or one credit card in weight) of plastic every week. We have seen the devastating effects plastic has on marine life. For instance, unable to process ingested plastic waste pieces, seabirds and other sea creatures starve to death. We have seen sea turtles and other animals tangled in fishing nets or trapped in plastic pack rings. Plastic pollution also wreaks havoc on land, clogging drains and preventing rainwater from soaking into the soil, which leads to flooding. Terrestrial creatures also suffer the effects of plastic waste, with some getting trapped in discarded plastic bags and suffocating to death.

- 177.** Plastic has distressing effects on
(a)only humans
(b)only marine life
(c)both humans and marine life
(d)none of the above
- 178.** Plastic and plastic particles can be found
(a)in the oceanic depths
(b)on mountain tops
(c)in meats and minerals
(d)all of the above
- 179.** Plastic pollution appears to be:
(a)an epidemic

- (b) a pandemic
- (c) a small menace
- (d) a temporal health issue

180. Plastic is considered an essential commodity because:

- (a) it has made our lives easier
- (b) it causes health hazard
- (c) it clogs natural ecosystem
- (d) it has multiple uses in our everyday lives

181. The word 'clogging' in the passage means:

- (a) obstruction
- (b) flow
- (c) opening
- (d) clearing

Directions: In this section, you have two short passage. After each passage, you will find some items based on the passage. First, read a passage and answer the items based on it. You are required to select your answer based on the contents of the passage and the opinion of the author only.

Passage-39

What is truth? Said jesting Pilate, and would not stay for an answer. Certainly there be, that delight in giddiness, and count it a bondage to fix a belief; affecting free will in thinking, as well as in acting. And though the sects of philosophers of that kind be gone, yet there remain certain discoursing wits, which are of the same veins, though there be not so much blood in them, as was in those of the ancients. But it is not only the difficult and labour, which men take in finding out of truth, not again, that when it is found, it imposeth upon man's thoughts, that doth bring lies in favour; but a natural though corrupt love of the lie itself. One of the later school of the Grecians, examineth matter, and is at a stand to think what should be in it, that men should love lies; where neither they make for pleasure as with poets, nor for advantage, as with the merchants; but for the lie's sake.

But I cannot tell; this same truth, is a naked, and open day-light, that doth not show the masks, and mummeries, and triumphs, of the world, half so stately and daintily as candle-lights. Truth may perhaps come to the price of a pearl, that showeth best by day; but it will not rise to the price of a diamond, or carbuncle, that showeth best in varied lights. A mixture of a lie doth ever add pleasure. Doth any man doubt, that if there were taken out of men's minds, vain opinion, flattering hopes, false valuations, imaginations as one

would, and the like, but it would leave the minds, of a number of men, poor shrunken things, full of melancholy and indisposition, and unpleasing to themselves?

182. What is the writers' idea of 'truth' in the paragraph?

[CDS - 2023 (2)]

- (a) Truth and divinity go hand-in-hand
- (b) Truth can be told and avoided conveniently
- (c) Truth is a compulsion sometimes
- (d) Truth may be a choice of ancient Grecians

183. Why do men love lies?

[CDS - 2023 (2)]

- (a) for advantage
- (b) for the love of lying
- (c) for the sake of lies
- (d) a lie is imaginative

184. Which metaphor is used in the passage to compare the value of truth and lies?

[CDS - 2023 (2)]

- (a) pearls versus diamonds
- (b) beauty versus plain unadorned truth
- (c) ease versus difficulty
- (d) deception versus sincerity

185. What literary device does the author use when he says, "truth is naked"?

[CDS - 2023 (2)]

- (a) symbolism
- (b) personification
- (c) allegory
- (d) paradox

186. What would happen if truths were not mixed with lies?

[CDS - 2023 (2)]

- (a) there would not be any pleasure in the pursuit of truth
- (b) truth would be clear and undiluted
- (c) lies would no longer be necessary
- (d) the beauty of truth would shine forth

Passage-40

The 'law' is an enterprise that seeks to rule us all from cradle to the grave, whether as constitution confronting custom, or as custom confronting constitution, and often indeed as the diverse combinatory prowess of both. The very notion of enterprise suggests risk-taking i.e. risk as a site for both opportunity as well as failure for regulation or felicitation of approved social conduct. At the same moment, this coupling of the constitutional and custom is

at the outset designed to pluralise the notion of legal literacy, a message yet to be fully constructed and conveyed co-equally to those who govern us and those who would resist domination. As citizens, we are supposed to know the law made by the state, whether we intend to obey it or break it. As members of cultural and religious communities, we also need to know the norms that define our membership of these collectives. Often, our identity and obligations as members of a political society and of diverse memberships within cultural and religious communities constitute spheres of peaceful coexistence. Often, too these collide. To decide what obligations ought to have precedence, each one of us in collision situations has to know a great deal about the law of the state and that constituting community and identity other than the political. Literacy in state law is important but never enough for an understanding of multiple sources of obligations that constantly press upon us. This invites engagement with many difficult questions including what we may want to mean by literacy, law domination, and resistance. Further, the question always is: how far do resources of legal literacy endow us with resources of justice for all and care of self and care for others?

187. According to the author, legal literacy
[CDS – 2023 (2)]

- (a) needs to be interpreted and understood in consonance with elements of social custom and justice
- (b) needs to be interpreted and understood in consonance with elements of economic and psychological factors and law
- (c) needs to be interpreted and understood in terms of unjust existence of human being and justice
- (d) needs to be interpreted and understood in consonance with elements of environmental conservation and law.

188. As a citizen one is supposed to:
[CDS – 2023 (2)]

- (a) make a balance between the legal aspects and cultural existence
- (b) give a priority to our cultural existence
- (c) give a priority to constitutional provisions
- (d) know that knowledge about constitutional regulation is an impediment to cultural existence

189. The above passage deals in:
[CDS – 2023 (2)]

- (a) Law and Justice
- (b) Legal Literacy
- (c) Literacy and Education
- (d) Constitutional Law

190. According to the writer 'diverse combinatory prowess' means:
[CDS – 2023 (2)]

- (a) A process of evolving a legal and constitutional system of cohesive elements
- (b) A provision of evolving a law of customary practices by avoiding constitutional provisions
- (c) A provision of evolving constitutional laws by neglecting customary practices.
- (d) A process of combining contrasting elements into a competent legal mechanism

191. Which among the following is closest in meaning to the word 'resistance'?
[CDS – 2023 (2)]

- (a) conforming
- (b) promotion
- (c) defiance
- (d) liberating

Directions: In this section, you have two short passages. After each passage, you will find some items based on the passage. Read the passage carefully and answer the items based on it. You are required to select your answers based solely on the contents of the passage and the opinion of the author, and indicate your response on the Answer Sheet accordingly.

Passage-41

Our tragedy today is a general and universal physical fear so long sustained by now that we can even bear it. There are no longer problems of the spirit there is only the question: when will I be blown up? Because of this, the young man or woman writing today has forgotten the problems of the human heart in conflict with itself which alone can make good writing because only that is worth writing about, worth the agony and the sweat. He must learn them again. He must teach himself that the basest of all things is to be afraid; and, teaching himself that, forget it forever, leaving no room in his workshop for anything but the old verities and truths of the heart, the old universal truths lacking which any story is ephemeral and doomed—love and honour and pity and pride and

compassion and sacrifice. Until he does so, he labours under a curse. He writes not of love but of lust, of defeats in which nobody loses anything of value, of victorious without hope and, worst of all, without pity or compassion. His greifs grieve on no universal bones, leaving no scars. He writes not of the heart but of the glands.

Until he relearns these things, he will write as though he stood among and watched the end of man. I decline to accept the end of man. It is easy enough to say that man is immortal simply because he will endure: that when the last dingdong of doom has clanged and faded from the last worthless rock hanging tideless in the last red and dying evening, that even then there will still be one more sound: that of his puny inexhaustible voice, still talking.

I refuse to accept this. I believe man will not merely endure : he will prevail. He is immortal, not because he alone among creatures has an inexhaustible voice, but because he has a soul, a spirit capable of compassion and sacrifice.

[CDS – 2024 (1)]

- 192.** The tragedy of our times is
 (a) we are unable to bear pain
 (b) we have forgotten the problems of the human heart
 (c) We have learnt ot bear general and universal physical fear
 (d) the feat of the spirit
- 193.** What must writers learn again?
 (a) the lessons of life
 (b) the problems of a heart in conflict with itself
 (c) to be afraid
 (d) to be fearless
- 194.** A writer's workshop should be filed with
 (a) stores of love and lust
 (b) stories of victories
 (c) universal truths
 (d) ephemeral facts
- 195.** According to the author, the end of man is untenable because
 (a) of his inexhaustible voice
 (b) of his endurance
 (c) of his mortal life
 (d) of his spirit, born of his soul
- 196.** The word 'puny' means
 (a) brave

- (b) daring
 (c) tiny
 (d) doomed

Passage-42

People do not understand the nature or ramifications of most educational changes. The y become involved in change voluntarily or involuntarily and in either case experience ambivalence about its meaning, form, and consequences. I have implied that there are a number of things at stake – changes in goals, skills, philosophy or beliefs, behavior, etc. Subjectively these different aspects are experienced in a diffuse, incoherent manner. Change often is not conceived of as being multidimensional. Objectively, it is possible to clarify the meaning of an educational change by identifying and describing its separate dimensions. Ignorance of these diemensions explains a number of interesting phenomena in the field of educational changes : for example, why some people accept an innovation they do not understand; why some aspects of a change are implemented and others not; why strategies for change neglect certain essential components.

The concept of objective reality is tricky. Reality is always defined by individuals and groups. But individuals and groups interact to produce social phenomena (constitutions, laws, policies, educational change programmes), which is also the reflection of the producers of change and thus simply a glorified version of their subjective conceptions. We can reduce this problem by following the practice of posing double questions : "What is the existing conception of reality on a given issue?" Followed quickly by "says who?"

[CDS – 2024 (1)]

- 197.** People doe not understand the nature or ramifications of edudcational change because
 (a) they do not understand the multidimensional character of change
 (b) they see the certainty in the change
 (c) they are ambiguous in their decision
 (d) it takes time and hard work
- 198.** People would accept an innovation with understanding, if
 (a) they find meaning of the innovation in their use

- (b) there is clarity regarding its aspects
- (c) they themselves learn to innovate in their contexts
- (d) they work with their immediate and distant colleagues

- 199.** What is the caution the author sounds with regard to 'objective reality'?
- (a) Objective reality is a collective reality which may have many problems
 - (b) Objective reality may be influenced by subjective thinking and considerations
 - (c) Objective reality is the collective influence of all people
 - (d) Objective considerations are part of the subjective reality and thus they are interrelated
- 200.** Which two words in the passage mean the opposite of the word 'whole'?
- (a) Version and ramifications
 - (b) Phenomena and programmes
 - (c) Components and dimensions
 - (d) Conceptions and programmes
- 201.** Which of the following sums up the idea of the author?
- (a) change is subjective and warrants objectively from conceptualisation to implementation
 - (b) Subjectively cannot be ruled out by describing the main dimensions of change
 - (c) It is difficult to conceptualise the change which satisfies all sections with understanding
 - (d) change has to be conceptualised collectively in its many dimensions, and dealt with objectively

Passage – 43

[CDS 2024 (2)]

It must not be imagined that a walking tour, as some would have us fancy, is merely a better or worse way of seeing the country. There are many ways of seeing landscape quite as good; and none more vivid, in spite of canting dilettantes, than from a railway train. But landscape on a walking tour is quite an accessory. He who is indeed of the brotherhood does not voyage in quest of the picturesque, but of certain jolly humours of the hope and spirit with which the march begins at morning, and the peace and spiritual repletion of the evening's rest. He cannot tell whether he puts his knapsack on, or takes it off, with

more delight. The excitement of the departure puts him in key for that of the arrival. Whatever he does is not only a reward in itself, but will be further rewarded in the sequel; and so pleasure leads on to pleasure in an endless chain. It is this that so few can understand; they will either be always lounging or always at five miles an hour; they do not play off the one against the other, prepare all day for the evening, and all evening for the next day.

Now, to be properly enjoyed, a walking tour should be gone upon alone. If you go in a company, or even in pairs, it is no longer a walking tour in anything but name; it is something else and more in the nature of a picnic. A walking tour should be gone upon alone, because freedom is of the essence; because you should be able to stop and go on, and follow this way or that, as the freak takes you; and because you must have your own pace, and neither trot alongside a champion walker, nor mince in time with a girl. And then you must be open to all impressions and let your thoughts take colour from what you see. You should be as a pipe for any wind to play upon. "I cannot see the wit," says Hazlitt, "of walking and talking at the same time. When I am in the country I wish to vegetate like the country" which is the gist of all that can be said upon the matter. There should be no cackle of voices at your elbow, to jar on the meditative silence of the morning. And so long as a man is reasoning he cannot surrender himself to that fine intoxication that comes of much motion in the open air, that begins in a sort of dazzle and sluggishness of the brain, and ends in a peace that passes comprehension.

- 202.** According to the passage, what is the primary purpose of a walking tour?
- (a) Seeing the landscape
 - (b) Quest of the picturesque
 - (c) Longing for pleasure
 - (d) Desire for education
- 203.** According to the passage, a walking tour should be gone upon alone because:
- (a) It is more in the nature of a picnic.
 - (b) He may put his knapsack on, or take it off, with more delight.
 - (c) It will add to individual excitement.

(d) It will provide freedom which is of the utmost importance.

204. According to the passage, what can adversely affect the walking tour ?

- (a) Walking and talking at the same time
- (b) Walking to rise above the everyday worries of life
- (c) Walking to experience the beauty of the surroundings
- (d) Walking to meditate in silence

205. According to the passage, how should a walking tour conclude ?

- (a) With the meditative peace above the real surroundings
- (b) With a peace that delights you
- (c) With The impressions of the surroundings
- (d) With the sounds of the birds around you

206. What is the meaning of the word "dilettantes" in the passage ?

- (a) Persons who cultivate an aesthetic pursuit without real interest
- (b) Professionals
- (c) Morning joggers
- (d) Schooled travelers

Passage-44

[CDS 2024 (2)]

Historical analysis combines several levels of thinking and study, posing a question about the past, setting up the problem in a form intended to facilitate its solution, solving the problem, and verifying the solution or interpretation. Academic history relies on formal analysis, based on rational and systematic apprehension of relevant evidence. Yet such formal analysis can be seen as a subset of the broader category of interpretation, including responses to evidence that are impressionistic and informal rather than formal and logically structured. Indeed, the many genres of academic and popular history run the full gamut from logically systematic to impressionistic. Historians come from a widely varying range of philosophical traditions, and the varying philosophies lead to quite different ways of posing questions and answers. The distinctions among philosophical principles sketched here help to show how it is that different analytical priorities arise on the main topics proposed for analysis; they also show how

historians can rely on similar data yet come to different or conflicting conclusions. Nineteenth century philosophical outlooks remain central to the world-historical analysis: most notably the dialectics of G.W.F. Hegel and the materialism of Karl Marx. Another great nineteenth-century current of thought was positivism, elaborated by Auguste Comte and focusing on study through breaking large problems into small ones, seeking deterministic relationship within the smaller problems. Philosophies of structuralism and post modernism have developed in more recent times, rejecting the positivist separation of problems into discrete sub-problems and emphasizing interaction among aspects of a problem.

207. Which of the following does not amount to historical analysis ?

- (a) Posing a question about the past, setting up the problem in a form intended to facilitate its solution.
- (b) Solving the problem and verifying the solution or interpretation.
- (c) Combines several levels of thinking and study to arrive at a conclusion.
- (d) Drawing from evidence to make impressionistic and informal conclusion.

208. "The many genres of academic and popular history run the full gamut from logically systematic to impressionistic" means :

- (a) The range of texts varies from those based on objective analysis and those based on subjective assertions.
- (b) Historical analysis that is rarely vague to that which establishes evidence.
- (c) Historical analysis that is always vague to that which establishes no evidence.
- (d) Historical analysis that is rarely systematic to that which establishes evidence.

209. What, according to the author, makes historians come to conflicting conclusions ?

1. They are influenced by their philosophical beliefs in asking questions on the same data.
2. They apply different interpretations on the same data.
3. They go for the primary data and evidence.
4. They are influenced by the current political developments.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

210. Which word(s) from the passage can be substituted for the assertion that "all events and human actions are ultimately shaped by causes external to the will" ?

- (a) Impressionistic
(b) Idealist approach to history
(c) Deterministic relationship
(d) Dialectics

211. Which one of the following relates to the post-modernist approach to History ?

- (a) Post-modernist approach builds On positivism
(b) Post-modernist approach emphasises interaction among aspects of a problem.
(c) Post-modernist approach rejects both; the separation of problems into sub-problems and interaction among them.
(d) Post-modernist approach supports separation of problems and interaction among them.

ANSWER KEY

1.	d	2.	a	3.	a	4.	b	5.	b	6.	d	7.	a	8.	c	9.	a	10.	c
11.	b	12.	a	13.	a	14.	a	15.	a	16.	b	17.	d	18.	c	19.	d	20.	b
21.	d	22.	a	23.	b	24.	c	25.	c	26.	c	27.	a	28.	a	29.	a	30.	c
31.	d	32.	a	33.	b	34.	c	35.	d	36.	d	37.	a	38.	b	39.	b	40.	b
41.	b	42.	b	43.	d	44.	b	45.	d	46.	b	47.	c	48.	d	49.	b	50.	a
51.	c	52.	a	53.	c	54.	d	55.	a	56.	d	57.	c	58.	a	59.	c	60.	c
61.	c	62.	b	63.	d	64.	a	65.	b	66.	c	67.	a	68.	c	69.	d	70.	c
71.	b	72.	b	73.	d	74.	c	75.	c	76.	c	77.	d	78.	d	79.	c	80.	b
81.	a	82.	a	83.	b	84.	d	85.	a	86.	c	87.	d	88.	c	89.	a	90.	b
91.	c	92.	b	93.	a	94.	b	95.	a	96.	a	97.	a	98.	b	99.	c	100.	c
101.	d	102.	a	103.	a	104.	a	105.	a	106.	a	107.	a	108.	c	109.	a	110.	b
111.	a	112.	d	113.	a	114.	c	115.	a	116.	d	117.	a	118.	b	119.	c	120.	a
121.	d	122.	a	123.	d	124.	a	125.	a	126.	c	127.	a	128.	b	129.	c	130.	b
131.	c	132.	a	133.	c	134.	d	135.	b	136.	a	137.	a	138.	a	139.	d	140.	b
141.	c	142.	a	143.	c	144.	c	145.	a	146.	b	147.	d	148.	a	149.	d	150.	a
151.	c	152.	b	153.	d	154.	a	155.	c	156.	d	157.	d	158.	d	159.	c	160.	b
161.	b	162.	c	163.	b	164.	a	165.	a	166.	c	167.	b	168.	a	169.	b	170.	b
171.	c	172.	a	173.	d	174.	d	175.	c	176.	d	177.	c	178.	a	179.	b	180.	d
181.	a	182.	b	183.	c	184.	a	185.	b	186.	a	187.	a	188.	a	189.	b	190.	d
191.	c	192.	c	193.	c	194.	c	195.	b	196.	c	197.	a	198.	b	199.	b	200.	d
201.	d	202.	c	203.	d	204.	a	205.	b	206.	a	207.	c	208.	a	209.	a	210.	a
211.	d																		

READING COMPREHENSION (NDA)

[NDA-2023(2)]

Passage 1

People by and large are concerned with and pursue self-interest. They are unlikely to be motivated to use renewable resources in a prudent and sustainable fashion. They are unlikely to be motivated under the following conditions if their resource catchments are Vast, so that degradation of any particular portion affects them very little; or if they open before them possibilities of substitution as any one resource element is depleted; or

if their control over the resource base is tenuous, so that others may, at any time, deplete a resource they value, even if they use it in a restrained fashion. Indeed, exhaustive use is highly likely when any one of these three conditions obtains. It is only when people perceive their resource catchments as limited, possibilities of substitution of exhausted resource elements as not readily feasible, and their own control over the resource base as secure, will they be motivated to use the resources in a prudent fashion. People, rooted in a locality, and retaining control over their resource base are most likely to fulfil all three prerequisites for sustainable resource use; and therefore to behave in ways conducive to the conservation of biodiversity within their localities.

1. Why, according to the writer can't people be motivated to use a resource prudently?
 - 1.They feel that others may overuse the resource
 2. It is possible to substitute the resource
 3. Abundance of the resource availability
 Select the correct answer using the code given below :

(a) 1 only	(b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only	(d) 1, 2 and 3
2. When do people use resources exhaustively?
 - (a) When the substitution of resource is felicitated by NGOs
 - (b) When the resource is about to expand
 - (c) When the resources use has little impact
 - (d) When they desire desperately for sustainable development
3. The self-interest of people affects the use of renewable resources

(a) positively	(b) erratically
(c) affirmatively	(d) indifferently

4. People rooted in a locality
 - (a) cause harm to available resources
 - (b) generate resources
 - (c) believe in conservation and re- production of resources
 - (d) consume resources freely
5. Which among the following is closest in meaning with the word deplete ?

(a) exhaust	(b) complete
(c) replete	(d) desperate

Passage 2

forest, a grassland, a pond, a coral reef or some other undisturbed area, is referred to as the area's biota or biotic community. The plant portion of the biotic community includes all vegetation, from large trees down through to microscopic algae. Likewise, the animal portion includes everything from large mammals, birds, reptiles and amphibians through to earthworms, tiny insects and mites. Microbes encompass a large array of microscopic bacteria, fungi and protozoans. Thus, the biotic community comprises plant community, an animal community and a microbial community.

The particular kind of biotic community found in a given area is, in large part, determined by abiotic factors such as the amount of water or moisture present, the temperature, the salinity, or the type of soil in the area. These abiotic factors both support and limit the particular community. For example, a relative lack of available moisture prevents the growth of most species of plants, but supports certain species, such as cacti; these kinds of areas are deserts. Land with plenty of available moisture and a suitable temperature supports forests. The presence of water is the major factor that sustains aquatic communities. The first step in investigating a biotic community may be simply to catalogue all the species present. Species are the different kinds of plants, animals and microbes in the community. A given species includes all those individuals which have a strong similarity in appearance to one another and which are distinct in appearance from other such groups. Each species in a biotic community is represented by a certain population – that is, by a certain number of individuals that make up the interbreeding, reproducing group.

6. Which one of the following does not belong to the biotic community ?
 (a) Water (b) Human
 (c) Protozoa (d) Bush
7. The nature of the biotic community largely depends on : 1. Biotic components 2. Abiotic components
 Select the correct answer using the code given below :
 (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
 (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
8. Which of the following is not an abiotic factor?
 (a) Temperature (b) Humidity
 (c) Algae (d) Moisture
9. In the passage, the word 'aquatic community' refers to:
 (a) Biotic community inhabiting the land
 (b) Biotic community found in water
 (c) Biotic community found in the air
 (d) Assemblage of rain and moisture
10. Species are defined on the basis of :
 (a) Similarities only
 (b) Differences only
 (c) Both similarities and differences
 (d) None of the above

Passage 3

[NDA-2024(1)]

We live in a time when globalisation is rapidly encompassing travel, information, trade and investment. The internet ties people together in ways unimaginable a few years ago. The globalisation of health, however, remains an elusive goal, similar to the globalisation of economic well-being. Laurie Garrett, in *The Coming Plague*, describes an unwelcome form of globalisation: the globalisation of disease. Garrett examines the recent history of emerging diseases such as AIDS, Ebola, Hantavirus, Rift Valley Fever, Legionnaires' disease, and others. She also explains the resurgence of familiar diseases like tuberculosis, cholera, and pneumonia as a consequence of the widespread and unwise use of antibiotics. Many of the new diseases are clearly linked to changes in land use, which brings humans into close contacts with rodents or other animals that harbour viruses previously unknown to medicine and often deadly to humans. Resurgent diseases, by contrast, are a creation of our medical practice. By treating people with antibiotics without restraint, we unknowingly

select strains that are immune to the antibiotics and that pass on their resistant genes to unrelated bacteria by way of plasmid transfer. The heroes of her book are the women and men on the frontlines of epidemiology. Garrett makes a plea for a greater commitment from our universities, medical schools, and government agencies to train workers who will be capable of recognizing new diseases and who will be able to move about equally well in the laboratory, the hospital and the field in pursuit of knowledge and public-health intervention around the world

11. What according to the passage is the 'unwelcome form of the globalization' ?
 1. Globalization of the diseases
 2. Elusive goal of globalization
 3. History of fatal diseases
 4. Selective use of antibiotics
 Select the correct answer using the code given below:
 (a) 1 only (b) 2, 3 and 4
 (c) 3 only (d) 1 and 4
12. According to the passage, globalisation of health has become imperative due to
 (a) the globalisation of diseases
 (b) public health intervention
 (c) the creation of new medical systems
 (d) the indiscriminate use of anti-biotics
13. According to the passage, resurgent diseases are affected by:
 1. Medical practices
 2. Overuse of antibiotics
 3. Emergence of new strains
 Select the correct answer using the code given below
 (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
 (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3
14. According to the passage, many new diseases are emerging due to change in land use because
 (a) humans are coming in contact with unfamiliar viruses
 (b) urbanisation makes pathogens proliferate
 (c) humans become adaptive and pass on their genes to related bacteria by way of plasmid transfer
 (d) humans are inadvertently releasing new viruses
15. What is the meaning of the word "epidemiology" in the passage ?

- (a) The historical study of the spread of diseases
- (b) The scientific study of the spread and control of diseases
- (c) The scientific study of the invention and uses of drugs
- (d) The scientific study of the uses of drugs

Passage 4

[NDA-2025(1)]

An attempt to determine the number of languages in the world is affected by other factors. A few new languages do continue to be discovered, even these days, as unexplored regions of the world begin to be opened up. The discovery does not usually take place straight away. Often there are similarities with an already known language which make the investigators assume that what they have found is just a dialect of that language. Only after a considerable period of contact does it transpire that the speech is so different that it has to be considered a different language. It takes a language survey to establish the facts, and there are still many countries where such surveys are incomplete or have not even begun. The people may be known, but the identity of their language may not be. Because many such people are bilingual or multilingual, and converse with outsiders in lingua franca, it may take a while before linguists come to realize that there is an ethnic language there at all.

- 16. Which one of the following is NOT the reason for the difficulty in estimating the number of languages of the world?
 - (a) New languages continue to be discovered
 - (b) There are still unexplored regions
 - (c) New languages are considered a dialect of a known language
 - (d) People who speak the language do not claim their language
- 17. Which one of the following is a way to establish the discovery of a new language?
 - (a) By establishing contact over a period of time with the speakers of the languages
 - (b) By finding the similarities of the language with other languages
 - (c) By comparing with the lingua franca of the region
 - (d) By conducting a survey of all languages of the region

- 18. Which one of the following statements is correct?
 - (a) Language surveys have been conducted by all nations
 - (b) There is hardly any language to be discovered in the world
 - (c) All the languages are either complete languages or dialects of other major languages
 - (d) No new language needs to be discovered since all languages are known to the world
- 19. 'The people may be known, but the identity of their language may not be,' means
 - (a) People are recognised as different ethnic groups but not necessarily their language
 - (b) People are recognised as different ethnic groups and their language is recognized
 - (c) People are not recognised as different ethnic groups, and so are their languages
 - (d) Because the people are not from different ethnic groups and their language is recognized
- 20. Which one of the following words from passage means 'come to be known'?
 - (a) Transpire
 - (b) Lingua franca
 - (c) Straight
 - (d) Variant

Passage 5

[NDA-2025(2)]

Can agricultural productivity meet human needs in the long run? Since twentieth-century advances, given increasing costs, do not seem sustainable, further increases in output will not be achieved easily. Global population growth, while showing signs of slowing down, has pushed farmers and breeders into areas unsuited to intensive agriculture, accelerating worldwide ecological disruptions. Reserves of arable land and fresh water have diminished alarmingly. Chemical runoffs have compounded pollution problems. Invasion of natural habitats have hastened species extinction. Desertification has been severe in the last hundred years, especially in North Africa, southern portions of Africa, Australia, northern Mexico, and the American Southwest. Tropical forests have shrunk by one-half since World War II, with agricultural pressures causing three-quarters of that loss. Government intervention has produced its share

of catastrophes, ranging from a terrible famine in China between 1958-1961 that may have killed 30 million people and destroyed the Aral Sea. Taking everything into consideration, we may remain hopeful about humankind's agricultural prospects, but we can scarcely look forward optimistically at the end of the first quarter of the twenty-first century.

- 21.** Why do twentieth-century advances not seem sustainable?
 (a) They do not meet the human needs
 (b) Industrialisation
 (c) Water scarcity
 (d) Desertification
- 22.** What pushes farmers into places unsuited for agriculture?
 (a) Population growth (b) Industrialisation
 (c) Water scarcity (d) Desertification
- 23.** Which one of the following is NOT true, according to the passage, for ecological degradation?

- (a) Global population growth
 (b) Excess use of chemicals
 (c) Desertification
 (d) World War II

- 24.** What is the conclusion of the author in the passage about the prospects of agriculture in the world?
 (a) The author is both hopeful and sceptical of the prospects of agriculture
 (b) The author is very hopeful of the prospects of agriculture
 (c) The author is sceptical of the prospects of agriculture
 (d) The author is neither hopeful nor sceptical of agriculture
- 25.** Which one of the following words means 'incursion'?
 (a) Invasion (b) Intensive
 (c) Severe (d) Intervention

ANSWER KEY

1.	d	2.	c	3.	d	4.	c	5.	a	6.	a	7.	b	8.	c	9.	b	10.	c
11.	a	12.	a	13.	d	14.	a	15.	b	16.	d	17.	a	18.	c	19.	a	20.	a
21.	c	22.	a	23.	d	24.	c	25.	a	26.		27.		28.		29.		30.	